

DEC 14, 2022 • 3 MIN READ • SSH

Use SSH Command with Password in Single Line

In this tutorial, you will use the SSH command with a password in a single line.



Introduction

One of the most popular ways to connect to Linux servers is through SSH. Many firewalls, routers, and other similar devices can also be accessed using ssh.

In this tutorial, you will learn to use the SSH command with a password in a single line.

What's the point, though?

There may be a lot of factors at play, such as the need to access a server, the need to execute a command from an automatic script using crontab, the desire to

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Whatever the situation, it is undeniable that THIS IS ONE OF THE MOST UNSAFE

WAYS TO ACCESS SERVERS since the instructions are recorded in history and the passwords may also be seen in a script, which means you are giving away the login and password to anyone with access to the system.

Without having to enter a login and password, there are alternative safe ways to SSH server securely.

SSH keys can be used for that, and we don't need to enter any usernames or passwords because public/private ssh keys allow a server to authenticate the server credentials using certificates (though we can use pass-phrase also for certificates). Refer this tutorial to set [passwordless ssh authentication](#).

Even so, read on if you need to use a one-liner command to use the ssh command with the password. We'll go over two different approaches to using the single-line ssh command with a password.

Use the `SSHPASS` Command

The excellent Linux program `sshpas` offers a straightforward method of non-interactive ssh login and will enter the ssh password for you. This must be installed on our system:

For Ubuntu

```
sudo apt install sshpass
```

For CentOS/RHEL

The EPEL repository contains the `SSHPASS` command, so we must first install that.

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```
yum install epel-release
```

After installation, execute the next command:

```
yum install sshpass
```

Using the `sshpas` command, let's examine how to utilize the `ssh` command with a password.

```
sshpas -p "ENTER PASSWORD HERE" ssh testuser@122.153.12.31
```

Here's an example:

```
ssh -p "MY@Password" ssh vegastack@122.153.12.31
```

As you can see, we utilized the `sshpas` command's option `p` to provide the password in this instance. But what if we need to access `ssh` on a server using a specific port? Here is another example of that.

```
ssh -p "MY@Password" ssh -p 2222 vegastack@122.153.12.31
```

The fundamental format for `sshpas` is to use the `sshpas` command, then the option for `sshpas`, and then the `ssh` command as usual.

Now, let's talk about the second approach.

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Use the `EXPECT` Command

Another crucial command that can be used to ssh with a password is `expect` command. Run the following command to install the `EXPECT` command on your Linux systems:

On Ubuntu

```
sudo apt install expect
```

On CentOS/RHEL

The EPEL repository contains the Expect command, so we must first install that.

```
yum install epel-release
```

Run the following command to set up the `expect` command on your system once it has been installed:

```
yum install expect
```

The one-liner command to use `expect` to ssh is:

```
ssh vegastack@122.153.12.31 ; expect "password:"; send "MY@Password\r"; interact'
```

So let's briefly explain this.

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- `-c` prefaces a command to be executed before any other command when used with the expect command.
- Expect "password:" to search for the password prompt.
- When prompted, sending "MY@Password\r" will transmit the password (add \r after you enter your password)

Additionally, a script might use this, for instance:

```
#!/usr/bin/expect -f

spawn ssh vegastack@122.153.12.31

expect "password:"

send "MY@Password\r"

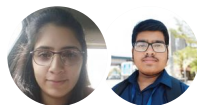
interact
```

Conclusion

In this tutorial, you used SSH Command with Password in Single Line 🙌.

If you have any queries, please leave a comment 🙋, and we'll be happy to respond to them.

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